Cairo, 2012

An Egyptian startup built a global product on a phone shake



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The problem every developer knows

The user says "the app is broken."

They can't explain what happened.

So you're left guessing.



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The fix: one gesture

Shake the phone and you get a screenshot, plus a report on the device and what happened before the bug.

The developer sees instead of guessing.



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Instabug: from Cairo to Y Combinator

Founded in Cairo in 2012. Got into Y Combinator.

Its customers became app companies outside Egypt.

Much of the team stayed in Cairo.



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They didn't solve an Egyptian problem

They picked a problem every developer in the world has.

In a market that doesn't care where you're from.



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Developer tools don't need a passport

If you're building from Cairo or Riyadh,
your market doesn't have to be the city around you.



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Save this

Test whether your idea can travel

1. Does the same person have this problem in every country?
2. Is it solved in one gesture, or does it need explaining?
3. Can the customer buy online without a meeting?
4. Does the product work without you next to it?



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I'm Mohammed. I build products, and the machine that sells them, from Riyadh.

Save this and come back to it before your next idea.

And tell me: what problem do you hit every day at work?



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